

Subject: Re: Potential hikes in Sequoia
Date: Monday, September 7, 2026 at 1:33:08 PM Pacific Daylight Time
From: Jason Morse
To: Duane Morse, Julia Morse, Diane Morse

Thanks Dad,

I started a list on all trails so we can save, collect, and download hikes for the trip. You can find it here:

- https://www.alltrails.com/lists/sequoia-trip-bdfce87?i=c445586d-aa39-4444-b8a2-68192505852b&utm_medium=collab_list_invite&utm_source=alltrails_virality

Using that link should add you as a collaborator so you can save additional items to the list. I put most of the hikes below on there, some of the ones like Heather Lake are part of the Lakes trail which I put on but I'll add the others when I get a chance.

I also tagged some of the ones like the General Sherman and Moro Rock trails which we will want to do for sure as short detours from the car. Some other stuff that looks cool:

- **Drives & Viewpoints** - General's highway, King's Canyon, etc.
- **Drive Through Tunnel Log** - A cheesy tree with a tunnel carved through it? Yes, please!
- **Crystal Cave** - 50 minute guided tours, will likely need tickets ahead of time
- **Wildlife/Halstead Meadow** - bring binoculars as there are some spots where bears are often visible
- **King's Canyon** - heading over there for a day or an afternoon would be cool

I'm in the process of writing stuff up in more detail but if anyone has other things they are excited about reply here and I'll add them.

Jason

Get [Outlook for Mac](#)

From: Duane Morse <Duane.Morse@outlook.com>
Date: Wednesday, September 2, 2026 at 12:14 PM
To: Jason Morse <jason.morse@live.com>; Julia Morse <julia.morse@gmail.com>; Diane Morse <dianemorse3425@gmail.com>; Duane Morse <Duane.Morse@outlook.com>
Subject: Potential hikes in Sequoia

I asked Copilot (Microsoft's AI) to recommend hikes in Sequoia near Three Rivers. Here are the parameters I set:

- Type: Out-and-back or loop
- Distance: 5–10 miles
- Elevation gain: 1,000–4,000 ft
- Drive time: All reachable from Three Rivers via the Ash Mountain entrance

Here is Copilot's response:

★ **Top 10 Hikes (5–10 miles, 1,000–4,000 ft gain)**

1. Heather Lake (via Lakes Trail)

- **Distance:** 8.2 miles
- **Gain:** ~2,000 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Alpine scenery, granite basins, and a classic Sierra lake.
- **Notes:** One of the best moderate–hard hikes in the park.

2. Pear Lake (via Lakes Trail)

- **Distance:** 12 miles (you can stop at Heather Lake to stay within 10)
- **Gain:** ~2,800 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Bigger alpine lake, dramatic cirque.
- **Notes:** If you want to stay within 10 miles, turn around at Heather Lake.

3. Alta Peak (to the summit saddle if you want ≤10 miles)

- **Distance:** 7–10 miles depending on turnaround
- **Gain:** 3,000–4,000 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Huge views of the Great Western Divide.
- **Notes:** Full summit is 13.6 miles; stopping at the saddle keeps it in your range.

4. Tokopah Falls + Upper Canyon Extension

- **Distance:** 5–7 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,000 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back

- **Why it's great:** Granite canyon, river views, waterfall.
- **Notes:** Extend past the falls for solitude and more elevation.

5. Marble Falls Trail

- **Distance:** 7.4 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,500 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Starts near Three Rivers; foothill wildflowers and a waterfall.
- **Notes:** Hot in summer; great shoulder-season hike.

6. Paradise Creek Trail (extended version)

- **Distance:** 6–8 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,200 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Quiet creekside hiking near Buckeye Flat.
- **Notes:** Lower elevation option if weather is bad up high.

7. Little Baldy

- **Distance:** 6 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,100 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Underrated summit with panoramic views.
- **Notes:** A perfect moderate hike with big payoff.

8. Big Baldy

- **Distance:** 6.4 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,200 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** Granite dome summit with sweeping Sierra views.
- **Notes:** Less crowded than Little Baldy.

9. Twin Lakes (partial route to stay within 10 miles)

- **Distance:** 8–10 miles (full route is longer)

- **Gain:** 2,000–3,000 ft
- **Type:** Out-and-back
- **Why it's great:** High-country scenery and lakes.
- **Notes:** Turn around at the ridge or first lake to stay within your distance window.

10. Crescent Meadow → Eagle View Loop (extended)

- **Distance:** 5–8 miles
- **Gain:** ~1,000 ft
- **Type:** Loop
- **Why it's great:** Meadows, giant sequoias, and a viewpoint few visitors reach.
- **Notes:** Build your own loop using the network of trails around Crescent Meadow.

Best picks for your group

Since you're **serious day hikers**, the top three that match your criteria *and* deliver the biggest reward are:

1. **Heather Lake**
2. **Alta Peak (saddle turnaround)**
3. **Big Baldy**

These give you the strongest combination of distance, elevation, scenery, and accessibility from Three Rivers.

You should be able to find all of these hikes in All Trails. Please take a look and let me know your thoughts, including whether my parameters are too aggressive, and whether we want to build in one or two days of touring rather than serious hiking while we're there.

Duane D. Morse
 3116 Valley Lane
 Falls Church, VA 22944
 Mobile: 703-447-2138
Duane.Morse@outlook.com